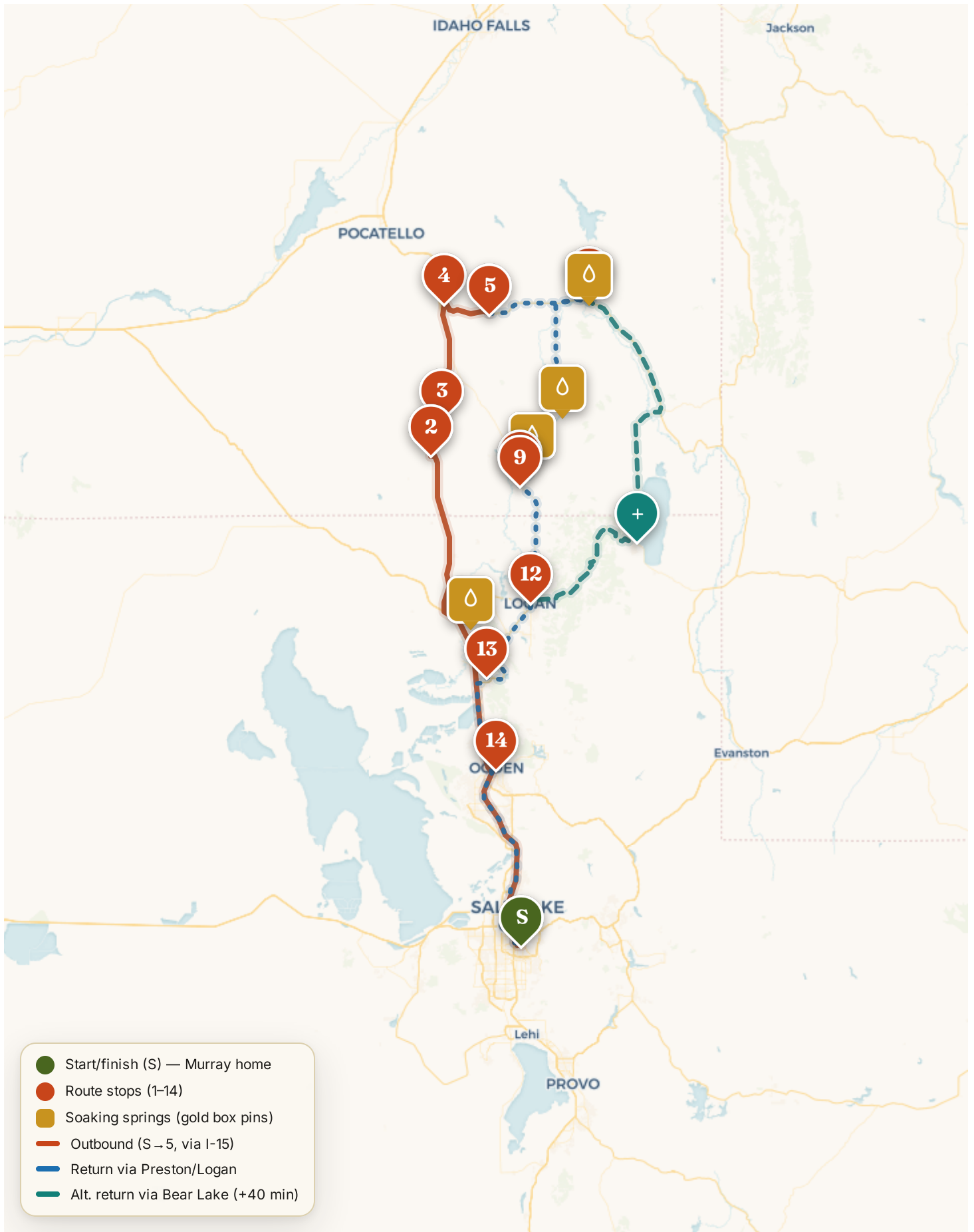




# Murray to Lava Hot Springs — and Home Again

Sunday, August 16 · Murray → Crystal Hot Springs → Malad → McCammon → Lava Hot Springs → Soda Springs → Preston → Bear River & Maple Grove Hot Springs → Logan → Brigham City → Ogden → Murray

## Two ways home from Soda Springs

|                                            |                   |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Murray → Lava Hot Springs                  | 161.7 mi · 2h 58m |
| Lava Hot Springs → Soda Springs            | 22.1 mi · 27 min  |
| — Soda Springs → Murray, via Logan & Ogden | 173.8 mi · 3h 44m |
| — Soda Springs → Murray, via Bear Lake     | 194.1 mi · 4h 23m |

The Bear Lake option (teal dashed line on the map) trades Preston and the Bear River Massacre site for Garden City's turquoise shoreline and a run down Logan Canyon — about 20 miles and 40 minutes longer, rejoining the original route (blue dashed line) at Logan. Neither total includes the optional gold-pin detours to Bear River Hot Springs or Maple Grove Hot Springs near Preston.



### Home — Murray, UT

4748 South Glencrest Road, Murray,  
UT 84107

Home base — starting and ending point of the loop.



### Crystal Hot Springs

8215 N Hwy 38, Honeyville, UT 84314

About 13 miles north of Brigham City on the way out, Crystal Hot Springs channels natural mineral water into a range of developed pools from cool to scalding, plus a large recreational pool and waterslide — an easy first soak of the trip, right off I-15. (Illustrative rendering — exact pools not photographed)



### Malad City — Oneida Pioneer Museum

27 Bannock St, Malad City, ID 83252

Malad City was settled in the 1860s largely by Welsh immigrants — it's said to have more residents of Welsh descent per capita than anywhere in the U.S. outside Wales. The Oneida Pioneer Museum documents that Welsh, Mormon-pioneer, and Shoshone history, and the 1917 Oneida County Courthouse anchors the small historic downtown a block away. (Idaho Heritage Trust)



### Devil Creek Reservoir

Devil Creek Reservoir, near I-15 Exit  
22, Malad, ID

Tucked into a break in the mountains just north of Malad Pass, Devil Creek Reservoir is stocked with rainbow trout by Idaho Fish & Game. It sits right alongside the highway, with views back down the Malad Valley. (Idaho Fish & Game)



### McCammon

McCammon, ID 83250

McCammon grew up in 1892 as the junction of the Oregon Short Line Railroad and the Utah & Northern Railway, earning it the old nickname "Junction City." It still carries some of that railroad-town character, including the historic Harkness Hotel, and marks the turnoff from I-15 onto US-30 toward Lava Hot Springs. (Wikipedia)

5

**Lava Hot Springs**

430 E Main St, Lava Hot Springs, ID 83246

The mineral hot pools here have drawn visitors for well over a century; the Shoshone-Bannock people are said to have treated the springs as neutral, sacred ground where rival tribes could bathe in peace. Today the state-run Hot Pools sit alongside a separate Olympic-size swimming pool and waterslide complex on the Portneuf River, with Main Street's shops and cafes a short walk away — the turnaround point of the day. ([lavahotsprings.org](http://lavahotsprings.org))

6

**Soda Springs Geyser**

39 W 1st S, Soda Springs, ID 83276

Drillers looking for a warm-water swimming pool in 1937 accidentally tapped a pressurized aquifer, creating a geyser so powerful the town had to cap it with a valve. It's now set on a timer to erupt roughly on the hour at Geyser Park downtown — an easy stop with picnic tables nearby. ([Visit Soda Springs](#))

7

**Hooper Springs Park**

1805 Government Dam Rd, Soda Springs, ID 83276

Hooper Spring was a documented stop on the Oregon and California Trails, where westbound emigrants paused to sample the naturally carbonated "soda" water the town is named for. A small stone pavilion still covers the spring today, and the shaded park around it makes a pleasant short break — about 2 miles north of the geyser, barely off the direct route. ([City of Soda Springs](#))

8

**Bear River Massacre Site**

US-91, Preston, ID 83263

On January 29, 1863, California Volunteer troops attacked a Northwestern Shoshone winter camp along the Bear River, killing an estimated 250–400 men, women, and children — more than at Sand Creek or Wounded Knee. A 1932 monument and newer interpretive panels, developed with the Northwestern Band of the Shoshone Nation, mark the bluff overlooking the site, directly on the route into Preston. ([Bear River Heritage Area](#))

9

**Preston — Historic Downtown**

36 S State St, Preston, ID 83263

Preston's unassuming downtown — including the Franklin County Courthouse, the old Deseret Industries thrift store, and Preston High School — became familiar to millions after Napoleon Dynamite was filmed here on a shoestring budget in 2003. Fans still stop for tater tots and to spot Rex Kwon Do landmarks. ([Grahm's Guide](#))

10

**Bear River Hot Springs**

3696 N 1600 E, Preston, ID 83263

A low-key, family-owned hot springs resort on the banks of the Bear River, with mineral soaking pools open year-round (hours vary by day). A short detour northeast of downtown Preston, it's a quieter alternative to Lava for a soak on the way home. (Illustrative rendering — exact pools not photographed)

11

**Maple Grove Hot Springs**

11386 Oneida Narrows Rd, Thatcher, ID 83283

Tucked into a river canyon along ID-34, Maple Grove is a 45-acre soaking retreat with four to six riverside mineral pools, a beach, hiking trails, and glamping yurts and cabins. It's farther off-route than the other springs — worth it only if there's time for the full detour. (Illustrative rendering — exact pools not photographed)

12

**Logan Tabernacle**

50 N Main St, Logan, UT 84321

Built between 1878 and 1891 from local limestone and timber, the Logan Tabernacle has served as a community gathering place for well over a century. It sits at the heart of Logan's walkable downtown in Cache Valley, with the larger Logan Temple visible on the bench above. ([Bear River Heritage Area](#))

13

**Box Elder Tabernacle**

251 S Main St, Brigham City, UT 84302

The original Box Elder Tabernacle burned in 1896 and was rebuilt within a year; its distinctive candlestick-topped tower and spires make it one of the most photographed buildings in northern Utah. Brigham City is the last stop before this drive rejoins I-15 south toward Murray. ([jacobbarlow.com](http://jacobbarlow.com))

14

**Ogden — Union Station**

2501 Wall Ave, Ogden, UT 84401

Opened in 1924 after fire destroyed its predecessor, Union Station once saw dozens of trains a day pass through Ogden's rail junction connecting the transcontinental line. The restored depot now houses the Utah State Railroad, Browning Firearms, and Browning-Kimball classic-car museums beneath its grand arched windows, with the shops, galleries, and restaurants of historic 25th Street a short walk away — a good last stretch-the-legs stop before the freeway home. (David Jay Fullmer, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons)

**Return to Murray, UT**4748 South Glencrest Road, Murray,  
UT 84107

The dashed blue route on the map traces the drive back from Ogden's Union Station down I-15 to Murray — about 42 mi, roughly 45 min.

Distances and drive times are approximate and do not include time spent at stops. Verify opening hours before visiting. © OpenStreetMap contributors for map & route data; sources cited inline.